

COMPREHENSION

READING PASSAGE FOR WORD

TOPIC 3: MEANING IN CONTEXT OR READING FOR CONTEXTUAL

MEANING

Contextual meaning of a word is the meaning of a word in relation to other words in the sentence. As we read a given passage, we come across some difficult words whose meanings we do not know. However, the surrounding words can help one understand the meaning.

Therefore, the meaning of such word ceases to depend on the single word but takes into consideration the context or the situation in which the word is used. Example

1. Our get-together comes by the month of August (month of the year)
2. I am expecting an august visitor (important visitor)

Uses

Contextual meanings are required in answering a comprehension questions that demand finding another word or phrase that means the same and can replace as used in the passage.

STEPS TO UNDERSTANDING WORDS FROM CONTEXT

1. Read the passage very well to gain general understanding of the passage.
2. Pay more attention to sentences with difficult words.
3. Try to figure out the meaning of such words not in isolation but with other surrounding words.
4. Replace it with another word that can fit in such environment or the context.
5. Read through the new words to make sure it fits in grammatically.

Assignment

In unit 7 of your new concept English, ans